Notes on Making Things

This is placeholder text for the third essay. Edit this file to change both the text shown on the site and the contents of the downloadable PDF — they are built from the same source.

Making things is how we think with our hands. An idea stays weightless until it is drafted, built, or shipped; only then does it push back and tell you what it actually wanted to be.

Prototypes over promises

A rough prototype teaches more in an afternoon than a month of planning. Build the smallest honest version, put it in front of reality, and listen. The work will correct you faster and more kindly than any critic.

Finish, then refine

Finishing is a skill of its own. The last ten percent — the edges, the naming, the quiet details no one is asked to notice — is where ordinary work becomes something people trust. Get to done, then make it good.

Replace these notes with your own lessons from making things. Keep the voice plain and specific; that is what makes advice worth keeping.